

Peter Penman

British Army Service Record, 1817-1836

Archival reference	The National Archives, WO 97/580/158
Digital provider	Findmypast - WO 97, Chelsea Pensioners British Army Service Records 1760-1913
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British Army Service Record for Private Peter Penman, 1817-1836, (findmypast.co.uk, WO 97 - Chelsea Pensioners British Army Service Records 1760-1913), TNA UK Reference: WO 97/580/158, Page 2, accessed 14 Jul 2020, [primary source]{S494}

Cautious synopsis

Peter Penman served as a private, regimental number 183, in the 42nd Regiment of Foot. The discharge papers state that he was born in the parish of Cockpen, in or near Edinburgh, in the county described in the record as Edinburghshire, and that he was a miner by trade. He attested at Edinburgh on 8 December 1817 at the age of 19.

His recorded service as a private ran from 8 December 1817 to 5 July 1836, amounting to 18 years and 210 days. A further 70 days were allowed from 6 July to his final discharge on 13 September 1836, giving total reckonable service of 18 years and 280 days.

The papers record that Penman landed at Gibraltar on 15 November 1826 and returned to England on 5 May 1832; the remainder of his service was at home. A regimental board assembled at Stirling Castle on 5 July 1836 to examine his service, conduct, character and cause of discharge.

Medical evidence describes severe varicose veins of the legs and later records chronic pulmonary disease as well. A medical opinion at Chatham dated 17 August 1836, after 21 days' treatment in the General Hospital, considered him unfit for service and likely to be permanently incapacitated for military duty. The board recorded the disability as contracted in service and not attributable to neglect, design, vice or intemperance.

His conduct was assessed favourably overall. The surviving wording indicates that the board regarded him as a good and efficient soldier, with his recent service affected by ill health. The discharge description gives his age as 38, height as 5 feet 10 inches, brown hair, hazel eyes, a swarthy complexion, and occupation as miner.

Key facts

Item	Reading	Confidence
Name	Peter Penman	High
Rank / number	Private / 183	High
Regiment	42nd Regiment of Foot	High
Birthplace	Cockpen, in or near Edinburgh	High
Trade	Miner	High
Attestation	Edinburgh, 8 Dec 1817, age 19	High
Gibraltar	15 Nov 1826 to 5 May 1832	High
Final discharge	13 Sep 1836	High
Reckonable service	18 years 280 days	High
Medical cause	Chronic pulmonary disease and severe varicose veins	High
Description	Age 38; 5 ft 10 in; brown hair; hazel eyes; swarthy complexion	High

Chronology

- 8 Dec 1817 - Attested at Edinburgh for the 42nd Regiment of Foot, age 19, occupation miner.
- 15 Nov 1826 - Landed at Gibraltar.
- 5 May 1832 - Returned to England; subsequently served at home.
- 5 Jul 1836 - Regimental Board proceedings at Stirling Castle; service to that date 18 years 210 days.
- 17 Aug 1836 - Chatham medical opinion after 21 days in the General Hospital: unfit for service and likely permanently incapacitated by chronic pulmonary disease and varicose veins of the legs.
- 13 Sep 1836 - Finally discharged after a further 70 days; total reckonable service 18 years 280 days.

Document inventory

Image	Document	Contents
01	Service and discharge statement	Identity, birthplace, trade, attestation, regiment, rank and service calculation; includes final-discharge t
02	Continuation of discharge statement	Overseas/home service, disability finding, character, pay and certification.
03	Regimental Board proceedings - first page	Board at Stirling Castle, 5 Jul 1836; identity, birthplace, trade, attestation and service.
04	Regimental Board service page	Private service calculation and Gibraltar/England movements.
05	Board continuation with medical memorandum	Surgeon note on severe varicose veins; character and pay sections.
06	Board continuation	Disability/cause-of-discharge finding, conduct/character and pay sections.
07	Board certification	Certification text and officers signatures.
08	Medical/discharge form with attached memorandum	Medical memorandum and physical-description form.
09	Medical opinion and discharge description	Chatham opinion dated 17 Aug 1836; physical description and trade.
10	Unused declaration / administrative page	Printed declaration form largely blank, with marginal manuscript notes; retained in the archival sequen

Uncertainties and research notes

- The record itself uses the county wording Edinburghshire. This package preserves that wording rather than replacing it with a modern or alternative county label.
- Some signatures and a small amount of character wording are difficult to read and have not been guessed.
- The pension-decision fields visible on the supplied discharge form do not contain a clearly readable completed pension award in these images; no pension amount is inferred.
- Image 10 is largely an unused printed declaration form. It is retained because it formed part of the supplied archival image sequence.

Suggested TNG wording

Source title: British Army Service Record for Private Peter Penman, 1817-1836

Short title: British Army Service Record - Peter Penman, 1817-1836

Call number: WO 97/580/158

Repository: The National Archives, UK

Provider: Findmypast

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Original record images

The following ten pages reproduce the supplied images in their original order. No page has been omitted, including the largely blank administrative declaration form at image 10.

226
Penman

D. *Peter Penman*

HIS MAJESTY'S

43rd REGT. OF FOOT

Whereof *Major Genl. Sir George Murray G.C.B. & G.C.H.* is Colonel.

No. *183 Peter Penman Private*

BORN in the Parish of *Cockpen* in or near the Town of *Edinburgh* in the County of *Edinburgh* by Trade a *Miner*

ATTESTED for the 43rd Regiment of Foot at *Edinburgh* in the County of *Edinburgh* on the *8th Decr 1817*, at the Age of *nineteen*

1st. SERVICE. AFTER the Age of 18 Years, *which he is entitled to reckon up to the 5th July 1836, is eighteen years two hundred & ten days, the statement of which is as follows*

Regiment.	Promotions, Reductions, &c.	Rank.	Period of Service in each Rank.		Amount of Service.	
			From	To	Years.	Days.
<i>43rd Regt Foot</i>		<i>Private</i>	<i>8th Decr 1817</i>	<i>5th July 1836</i>	<i>18</i>	<i>210</i>

For Soldiers enlisted previous to the 15th March, 1818.

INDIES	From	To	Years.	Days.	

* WATERLOO

Total of the foregoing Statement *18 210*

Deduct

Total Service up to the *5th July 1836* *18 210*

Years.	Days.
<i>X</i>	<i>X</i>

A Non-commissioned Officer, enlisted after the 14th November, 1829, must have served not less than Three Years without interruption as such, immediately preceding his discharge. Vide Art. 6 of the Pensioner Regulations.

Of which, as Corporal
Serjeant
Serjeant-Major

* Further Service from the *5th July 1836* to the *13th Sept 1836* when finally discharged *" 40*

Total Service allowed to reckon to the day of final discharge. *18 250*

* To be erased, when not required, by drawing the Pen through the Lines.

SERVED.

Landed at Gibraltar B.th Regt 1826
 Returned to England 3.rd May 1832
 Remained at home

2nd.
 DISABILITY,
 or Cause of
 Discharge.

According to the surgeon's report
 it appears that this is a case of disability
 contracted on duty, without being attributable
 to neglect, disease, vice or intemperance
 and the Board concurs with the surgeon

3rd.
 CHARACTER.

The Regimental Board is of opinion, that his general
 conduct has been that of a good soldier
 & efficient all within the last twelve months from
 ill health, seldom in hospital, trustworthy
 & sober

4th
 PAY and
 CLOTHING.

He has received all just Demands from his Entry into the Service, up to the
 5th July 1836

Peter Penman Pte

Certified

J. Compton Esq. Captain.

I CERTIFY that the foregoing Statements are correct Extracts from the
 Regimental Records, and the Proceedings of the Regimental Board.

Geo. W. L. Capt Major, and President.

Confirmed by me,

Macdonald

Major
 Lieutenant Colonel Commanding.

Witnessed at 5th July 1836

Forwards receive his Pension at Newark upon Trent

Proceedings of a Regimental Board, held
in conformity to the Articles of War, for the purpose of verifying
and recording the Services, Conduct, Character, and cause of
Discharge of No 183 Peter Penman Private of the
Forty Second Regiment of Foot

Stirling Castle
5th July 1826

President { Captain Geo. McTear
Members { Captain L. Hope
 { Captain J. Leslie

Peter Penman appeared, and the Board having
personally examined and compared the Regimental
Records, the Soldier's Book, and other documents,
report to the following effect,

Born, { in the Parish of Cockpen in or near the Town
 { of Edinburgh in the County of Edinburgh
 { by Trade a Miner

Attested, { for the 42nd Regiment of Foot at Edinburgh
 { in the County of Edinburgh on the 5th Dec^r
 { 1817, at the Age of nineteen

Service { which he is entitled to reckon, after making every
 { deduction required by His Majesty's Regulations
 { up to the 5th July 1826 is eighteen years
 { Two hundred and ten days the
 { details of which, as extracted from the Regimental
 { documents, are stated on the following page.....

Regiment.	Promotions Reductions &c.	Rank.	Period of Service in each Rank.		Amount of Service.	
			From	To	Years.	Days.
42 ^d	"	Private	8 th Dec 1817	5 th July 1836	18	240
"	"					

Served Landed in Gibraltar 15th Nov. 1825
 Returned to England 5th May 1832
 Remaining period at home

Private Peter Penman

Has venereal sores of the legs to such a degree
as to render him incapable of Military duty;
and there is no chance of improvement
from medical treatment

Petersen M.D.
Surgeon W. Highlanders

Conduct
and
Character

The Officers composing the Board having
examined the Defaulter's Book, and received
parole testimony from Captain Lyle
are of opinion that his conduct
has been that of a good and efficient
soldier, with the exception of the last
twelve months from ill health, seldom
in Hospital last month & so on

Pay and
Clothing

Peter Penman being asked up to what
period he has been paid, answered that his
Account was balanced up to the ~~end of the~~ 5th July 1830
present Month, being further asked whether he
has any other claim on the Regiment for Arrears
of Pay, Allowances, or Clothing, answered, that
he had no unsatisfied claim
whatever

Disability or
Cause of Discharge. } According to the Surgeons
report & mixed it appears
this is a case of disease
or disability contracted in and by the
Service without being attributable to
neglect, design, vice or intemperance.
A constitutional disease, and the
Board concurs in the opinion of the
Surgeon -

Conduct
and } The Officers composing the Board having
Character } examined the Defaulter's Book, and received
parole testimony from Captain Lybe
an opinion that his conduct
has been that of a good and efficient
Soldier, with the exception of the last
winter months from ill health, seldom
in Hospital trustworthy & sober

Pay and
Clothing. }

Peter Penman being asked up to what
period he has been paid, answered that his
Account was balanced up to the ~~end of the~~ 5th July 1828
present Month, being further asked whether he
has any other claim on the Regiment for Arrears
of Pay, Allowances, or Clothing, answered, that
he had no unsatisfied claim
whatever

The Board have verified that his Soldier's Book is correctly balanced, and signed by the Officer Commanding his Company, and they further declare that they have impartially enquired into and faithfully reported their Opinion on all the matters brought before them, in accordance with the Regulations and Instructions issued by His Majesty's Orders.

Geo. W. Her. Capt. & President

L. Fyfe Capt. 42nd Regt.

Wm. Leslie Capt. 42nd Regt.

Conformed and approved

Massena Major Genl.

Note... It is desired that this size and form of report may be invariably adhered to.

By Authority.

London.. Printed & Sold by W. Clowes & Sons, 14, Chancery Lane.

Private Peter Penman

Has been ill since the 1st of Sept. to such a degree
as to render him incapable of military duty; and
there is no chance of improvement from medical
treatment.

Peter Penman M.D.

Surgeon Royal Highland Regt.

Confirmed

John Garroch
A.D.C.

DECISION. The Commissioners award to receive a Pension of
a day, commencing

Secretary, or Chief Clerk.

DESCRIPTION Of Peter Penman at the time of his Discharge.

He is 38 Years of Age, 5 Feet 10 Inches in Height, brown Hair,
hazel Eyes, Swarthy Complexion.

By Trade a Miner

When he left the Regiment, Donald Gibson was the Pay-Serjeant of
his Company.

MARCHING
ALLOWANCE.

received from

at

on the

Days' Marching Allowance,

to carry him to

the place of his enlistment, or to

the Port at which he is to embark on the way to the place of his

enlistment.

OPINION.

Of the Principal Medical Officer, at

Chatham August 11 1836

after a treatment of 21 days in this General Hospital, I am of opinion that Peter Penman is unfit for service & is likely to be permanently incapacitated for military duty by chronic pulmonary disease & by varicose veins of legs. J. Davy ap. Surgeon of H.M.

Horse Guards, 12th Sept 1836

Confirmed

John Garroch
A.D.C.

DECISION.

The Commissioners award
a day, commencing

to receive a Pension of

Secretary, or Chief Clerk.

DESCRIPTION

Of Peter Penman at the time of his Discharge.

He is 30 Years of Age, 5 Feet 10 Inches in Height, brown Hair,

hazel Eyes, healthy complexion.

By Trade a Miner

When he left the Regiment, Donald Wilson was the Pay-Serjeant of his Company.

MARCHING ALLOWANCE.

received from

at

on the

Days' Marching Allowance,

to carry him to

the place of his enlistment, or to

the Port at which he is to embark on the way to the place of his

enlistment.

*Declaration to be made and signed when the Soldier receives his Discharge
at his own request.*

[See Article 48 of the Pensioner Warrant, dated 14th November, 1829.]

I, _____ in the _____ of _____
hereby declare that I do, of my own free will, request to be discharged from His Majesty's Service ;
and I further declare, that a period of not less than Thirty Days has elapsed since I first made
application for my Discharge ; and it has been fully explained to me, and I perfectly understand,
that in receiving my Discharge at my own request, I entirely relinquish all Claim to Pension, and
that, even if I should re-enlist, my past Services prior to the Date of my present Discharge cannot
be allowed to be reckoned for the purpose of obtaining any benefit from Chelsea Hospital.

Signed in presence of _____ Officer Commanding the Company,
at _____ this _____ day of _____

Witnessed and certified by me,
_____ Officer Commanding the Company.

411 570 for inc. 1831

Pen 14/19/31

5th

Pen 14

March 1831

Regt.

Service and of the

1831

1831

Peter Penman

42nd

BY AUTHORITY.
London: Printed and Sold by WILLIAM CLOWES and SONS, 14, Charing Cross

Penman
1831
1831